

The 6:15

TUESDAY · SEPTEMBER 22, 2026

NO. 18

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Thu 9/24	Initial jobless claims (wk. of 9/19), 8:30a ET
Fri 9/25	Durable goods orders (Aug.), 8:30a ET
Sat 9/26	Northwestern at No. 5 Indiana, 7p ET (FOX)
This wk.	UN General Assembly: Trump-Zelenskyy sidelines meeting expected; US-Denmark Greenland security pact signing expected — no fixed dates confirmed this run
Mon 9/28	SpaceX Starship Flight 14 (orbital), Starbase, 8:15-9:30a ET window — NET, pending FAA [slipped from 9/22]
Wed 9/30	Micron fiscal Q4 earnings, after mkt.
Thu 10/1	Nike fiscal Q1 earnings [date not independently confirmed]
Tue 10/27–Wed 10/28	FOMC; rate decision 2p ET Wed., SEP/dot plot released

OPEC+ JMMC meets in October; exact date not confirmed this run (carried from issue No. 17). Today (9/22): 11 companies report per generic earnings-calendar count; no marquee name verified this run.

METRICS · TIMES ET; MON. 9/21 SETTLE UNLESS NOTED

Brent	Settle \$100.06 (-3.67%, Mon.); \$98.28 (-2.05%) live quote 6:05a [still sliding pre-open]
WTI	Settle \$93.93 (Mon.); \$89.87 (-2.71%) live quote 6:05a
Brent-WTI spread	~\$8.41 (morning quote basis)
10Y / 30Y	4.97% (-3bp, Mon.) / 5.31% (Mon.)
2Y	not confirmed as of press time (last: 4.75%, Fri. 9/18)
DXY	100.23 (Tue. open), up from 99.98 Fri.
VIX	not confirmed as of press time (a live tracker showed 14.93 but its as-of date was unreconcilable)

this run; last confirmed 14.81, Fri.)

Gold	\$4,307.63 to ~\$4,350/oz — trackers disagree on direction intraday [see note]
S&P / Nasdaq / Dow	7,764.70 (+1.49%) / 27,122.09 (+2.26%, record close) / 52,048.83 (+0.71%) — Mon.
Asia	Nikkei closed (holidays thru Wed.); Hang Seng 25,042.71 (+1.18%, Mon.); Shanghai Comp. 3,949.91 (+0.97%, Mon.)
Europe	FTSE 100 +0.5-0.75% (sources disagree on level: 10,739 vs. 14,354 [unreconciled]); DAX 25,575.01 (+1.07%, Mon.)
Retail gas	\$4.4786/gal natl. avg. (AAA, Tue.), up from \$4.4687 Fri.

Crude via ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month; rates via Fed H.15/CME; equities via exchange closes/CNBC/Bloomberg. Gold note: a tracker checked this run puts the all-time high at \$5,589.38 (Jan. 28, 2026) — which would mean Friday's \$4,415.90, logged here as a record in issue No. 17, was not one. Unreconciled this run; "record" framing dropped pending verification.

HORMUZ COUNTERS · AS OF ~6:15A ET (STRAITS.LIVE, UNLESS NOTED)

Status	Day 205 since closure declared; "contested" between Iran's declaration and observed transits
Transits	PortWatch: 8, 9/13, vs. 85/day baseline (9%). Kpler (separate, unreconciled framings): 6/11/5 on consecutive early-Sept. days (10-day avg. 13/day); ~40% of 2025 flows since the Aug. 17 MOU lapse; <10/day weekends, ~15% of prewar
Dark tankers	63 AIS-dark/24h of 205 screened (1.5× the 56.2 7-day baseline) — straits.live; a separate %-of-total measure (issues No. 16/17): ~57% of conflict-period transits, peaked 65.2% in May
War-risk premia	40.0× pre-crisis, ~\$10.0M/VLCC passage, 6 P&I clubs have withdrawn cover (straits.live); issue No. 16's separate read: 3%-10% of hull value, ~\$21M high end on a \$210M VLCC
Strikes	LR Stephanie (72,825 dwt, Isle of Man), hit by unidentified projectile entering the strait, 2 crew injured, transit continued — UKMTO's 4th logged tanker strike since 9/17

Methodology note (required every issue): PortWatch, Kpler's three separate framings, the dark-tanker count/share, and the two war-risk premia figures each measure a different thing over a different window and unit — vessel counts, barrels, percentages, dollars, multiples of baseline. Never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Lost the Arizona finale 8-4 Sun. 9/20 (Arenado grand slam); series lost 1-2. 89-65, +10½ games clear in the AL wild card
Knicks	Preseason schedule confirmed: open at Philadelphia Mon. 10/5, home opener vs. Washington 10/8 (MSG). No roster move reported
Northwestern	No move since Sat.'s win; next at No. 5 Indiana, 9/26

LEAD

CROSS-ASSET

Oil sinks, stocks hit records, yields ease — on a Hormuz peace the water itself hasn't confirmed

Monday's session moved every major asset class in the same direction at once, and it is worth being precise about why before the market extrapolates further. Brent settled at \$100.06, down 3.67% on the day, and was still sliding before Tuesday's open — \$98.28 on a live quote at 6:05a ET; WTI settled at \$93.93 and traded as low as \$89.87 pre-open, down 2.71% intraday. [NEW] The 10-year eased three basis points to 4.97%, off the 5.02% intraday high from Sept. 15 that issue No. 17 flagged as the highest since 2007. [continuity] And equities did not just drift higher on the lower discount-rate, lower-input-cost math: the Nasdaq Composite closed at a record 27,122.09, up 2.26%, with the S&P 500 up 1.49% to 7,764.70 and the Dow up 0.71% to 52,048.83. [NEW] A single session with crude down mid-single-digits, yields easing, and equities up 1.5%-2.3% is a textbook geopolitical-risk-premium unwind. [read]

The mechanism being priced is specific: U.S. Central Command said Monday that oil "is moving" through the strait and that "momentum is building" toward normalization — a claim from an interested party, not an independent count. [flag] It sits on top of the unconfirmed Iran-Oman reopening framework Foreign Minister Araghchi floated over the weekend (issue No. 17), which Oman still has not confirmed as of this run. [continuity/DEVELOPING] Together, CENTCOM's momentum language and the still-unconfirmed Omani claim are doing a lot of work for a multi-percent single-session move across three asset classes.

What the water itself shows does not support that scale of repricing. The same Monday CENTCOM was talking up momentum, UKMTO logged its fourth tanker strike since Sept. 17: the LR Stephanie, a 72,825-dwt Isle of Man-flagged tanker, hit by an unidentified projectile while entering the strait, two crew injured, the vessel proceeding onward. [NEW] Straits.live's tracker still describes the closure as "contested" rather than lifted, and the hard transit data — IMF PortWatch's 8-vessel count against an 85/day pre-crisis baseline, Kpler's various framings ranging from 13/day (10-day average) to sub-10/day on weekends — shows nothing like a volume recovery that would independently justify Monday's move on an "oil is flowing again" thesis. [read] War-risk premia, per straits.live, remain 40 times the pre-crisis baseline, with six protection-and-indemnity clubs having withdrawn coverage altogether — not the signature of a market that has actually stopped pricing strike risk. [read]

Some caution is warranted before reading Monday purely as a Hormuz trade, though: the same session carried a distinct and well-documented driver for the equity leg specifically. AMD closed above

a \$1 trillion market cap for the first time, the fourth U.S. chipmaker to do so, as Meta's Muse AI agent hit No. 1 on the App Store two weeks after launch and reignited AI-infrastructure demand bets — the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index rose roughly 4.3% on the day. [NEW, see Technology] That is a genuine, independently sourced reason for tech-heavy indices to rally that has nothing to do with the strait. The overlap makes Monday's tape harder to read cleanly: some of the equity strength is coincident with the oil-and-rates move, not caused by it.

What is unambiguous is the setup into a five-week gap before the next FOMC decision (Oct. 27-28): the market is now pricing a meaningful de-escalation in the Gulf on the strength of one interested party's "momentum" language and one unconfirmed diplomatic claim, against a strait where a tanker took a projectile hit on the same day. If Oman denies the corridor claim, or the next strike lands on a larger or more strategically resonant target, Monday's unwind has real room to reverse — and reverse across three asset classes at once, not just oil. [read] The asymmetry is the trade to watch this week: a confirmation from Muscat would validate Monday's move and likely extend it, while a denial or another high-profile strike would leave crude, rates, and the risk-on equity tape all repricing back in the same direction they just came from — a three-asset round trip that would be unusual outside of an actual war.

POLITICS

CNN, MS NOW and Politico filed suit against the Trump administration Monday morning over the White House press-credential revocations that took effect Sept. 19 (issue No. 17), arguing the bans violate the First Amendment; all three outlets

remain barred from the complex as of this run. [NEW, multi-sourced: CNN, NBC News, Time, Hollywood Reporter] Separately, the White House press pool suspended its televised coverage of the President after CNN — which holds the rotating pool-camera slot — was pulled from that duty; no restoration of pool TV coverage has been reported. [fact] No ruling or hearing date on the lawsuit was located this run. [flag] The White House Correspondents' Association's demand for restored access, issued when the ban first took effect (issue No. 17), has not been answered; the administration has not filed a public response to the suit as of this run. [continuity]

ECONOMICS

The data calendar is thin until Thursday: initial jobless claims for the week of Sept. 19 are due 8:30a ET Thu. 9/24, with durable goods orders (August) following Fri. 9/25, same time. [NEW dates confirmed this run] The most recent claims print located, for the week ended Sept. 12, came in at 196,000, below the 207,500 consensus and down 10,000 week-over-week — a four-week average of 203,250 — consistent with the "employers holding onto workers" read this issue has carried for several weeks. [continuity] The rates backdrop is the more active story this run: the 10-year eased to 4.97% Monday but the 30-year sits at 5.31%, and a steep long end alongside easing oil is an unusual combination worth watching into Thursday's claims print for confirmation either way. [read] No fresher GDP or PCE date was independently confirmed this run beyond the general week-of-9/22 cluster issue No. 17 flagged. [flag] Existing home sales and wholesale inventories, both previously flagged as clustering around this week, also did not turn up independently confirmed release dates this run; treat the whole

cluster as indicative until a primary-source calendar confirms it directly.

BUSINESS

Warren Buffett stepped down as Berkshire Hathaway chairman, effective immediately, per a letter to shareholders dated Sept. 18 — first reported this issue, four days after the fact, since it fell inside issue No. 17's weekend edition cut. [NEW to this issue] Buffett, 96, becomes chairman emeritus and remains on the board; his son Howard G. Buffett becomes chairman, eight months after Greg Abel succeeded Buffett as CEO. [fact, multi-sourced: CNBC, Washington Post, NPR, Axios] Buffett's own framing, from the letter: "Greg runs the company; Howard will guard its culture and values." [quote] Separately, HP shares fell more than 3% Monday after the company declined to give fiscal 2027 guidance, citing an expected mid-single-digit decline in industrywide PC unit volumes next year versus 2026. [NEW] Greenland-linked U.S. equities spiked in Monday trading — Greenland Energy up more than 144% premarket — on the security-pact news covered in Geopolitics below; treat as a thinly traded, headline-driven move rather than a fundamentals signal. [read] None of Monday's Business items are Hormuz-adjacent, which is itself notable: the market's largest single-day repricing of Gulf risk in weeks landed on a session where the corporate news flow was dominated by a 60-year succession story and a PC-demand guide-down — a reminder that the oil move in the Lead was a macro, not a sector, event.

TECHNOLOGY

AMD closed above a \$1 trillion market capitalization for the first time Monday, up roughly 10% on the day, becoming the 14th U.S. company and the fourth chipmaker (after Nvidia, Broadcom and Micron) to cross that threshold. [NEW, multi-sourced: Bloomberg, Semafor, GuruFocus] The catalyst was Meta's Muse AI agent, which hit No. 1 on Apple's U.S. App Store free-app chart roughly two weeks after launch; traders read the uptake as evidence that agentic AI's live-inference demands will need more CPU capacity alongside GPUs, driving Intel and Arm Holdings to lead Nasdaq-100 gainers alongside AMD and pushing the Philadelphia Semiconductor Index up ~4.3% on the session. [read] Separately, xAI released Grok 4.7 on Sept. 21 [NEW, single-sourced this run, flagged accordingly]. No new development on the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal, the Anthropic IPO timeline, or the OpenAI-Anthropic Navier-Stokes dispute was located this run (continuity from issue No. 16).

GEOPOLITICS

Trump announced Monday that the U.S. and Denmark reached a deal giving Washington "permanent control" over Greenland's security, with a formal signing expected during this week's UN General Assembly session; the pact would bar U.S. adversaries from bases, military presence, or "sensitive investments" on the island without American sign-off, and Trump claimed it comes at "NO COST to the United States." [NEW, multi-sourced: CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera] The deal follows months of Trump threats to annex the territory by force; how a security guarantee differs in practice from the annexation threat it replaced was not addressed in what was located this run, and no text of the pact itself has been published as of this run — the reporting to date is characterizations from Trump's own remarks, not a document. [flag] Separately, Zelenskyy said he will meet Trump on the UNGA sidelines this week to press for an energy ceasefire with Russia, as Russian drone strikes on Sumy killed a woman and injured her husband and further strikes hit three districts of the Kyiv region. [DEVELOPING] Ukraine's general staff puts cumulative Russian combat losses since February 2022 at roughly 1.52 million, including 1,660 in the prior 24 hours — Kyiv's own count, not independently verified, and flagged as such. [flag, single-sourced]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Board's counters and the Lead's market read, the core picture is unchanged in direction if not in degree: attacks on shipping continue (the LR Stephanie strike), the Iran-Oman reopening claim remains unconfirmed by Oman, and the multilateral Salalah meeting

has no rescheduled date (continuity from issues No. 15-17). [continuity] Straits.live's framing of the closure as "contested" — rather than either fully closed or reopened — is arguably the most accurate one-line summary of where the strait actually stands this run, and it is the framing Monday's market move does not obviously reflect. [read] For a reader positioning around the strait specifically rather than the broader macro tape, the more useful signal this run is less the headline oil print than the war-risk premia and P&I-withdrawal data in the Board: insurers repricing risk 40 times over and six clubs pulling coverage entirely is a harder-to-fake signal than a CENTCOM statement, and it has not moved in the direction Monday's oil settle implies.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost the Arizona finale 8-4 Sun. (Arenado grand slam); series lost 1-2.
	89-65, +10½ games clear atop the AL wild card.
Knicks	No roster move; preseason opens 10/5 at Philadelphia.
	Home opener 10/8 vs. Washington, MSG.
Northwestern	2-0; next at No. 5 Indiana, Sat. 9/26, 7p ET (FOX).

Continuity. No issue ran Mon. 9/21; this issue covers from Fri. 9/18's weekend edition (No. 17) through Monday's close and Tuesday's premarket. Dropped as unchanged: the Salalah reschedule date, the exact OPEC+ October JMMC date, the Russia energy-sanctions bill's signing status, and the Nvidia-Hugging Face/Anthropic IPO/OpenAI-Anthropic items (no movement located). The fire-pause-on-land counter from issue No. 17 was not refreshed this run — carried forward without a new read.

Unverified figures are marked in red: the 2Y yield, VIX, gold's direction and record status, and the FTSE 100's level. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.